international norms, diminishing the authority of global governance as a whole.

Moreover, in an era of heightened geopolitical competition, IOs' actions to counter populism hold significant implications for the liberal international order. Populists' antagonism toward global governance weakens Western-led institutions and creates openings for revisionist powers like China to assert their influence. During Trump's first presidency, for instance, Chinese president Xi Jinping seized the moment to bolster China's role in the WTO and portray his country as a global leader on climate change after the United States withdrew from the Paris Agreement.[12] These dynamics reveal a dangerous paradox: While IOs work to defend themselves from populist threats, their responses can inadvertently strengthen alternative powers, both from within and beyond the institution.

The cumulative effect of these responses can reshape IOs' standing on the global stage, forcing them to walk a fine line between preserving their authority and risking unintended consequences. While appeasement and reform may preserve status quo levels of engagement, they risk compromising transparency and legitimacy. Conversely, sidelining and confrontation can isolate populist states but may deepen divisions and embolden revisionist powers. Our findings thus underscore both the resilience and fragility of Western-led organizations, as well as the stakes involved in their continued global leadership.

In the concluding chapter, we argue that IOs can mitigate these risks by carefully weighing the costs and benefits of their strategies and striving for a balanced and comprehensive approach. Flexibility and adaptability are crucial if IOs are to endure populist episodes without compromising their legitimacy or fueling further backlash. As *Global Governance Under Fire* demonstrates, IOs possess the tools necessary to survive—but only if they leverage them strategically, judiciously, and with an eye toward long-term stability. By bending to the pressures of populism without breaking, IOs can navigate the turbulence of today's political landscape while safeguarding their role in tomorrow's global governance.